

Extract 1

Ever since Sentila became old enough to accompany her mother to the fields and forests, she began to dream of becoming a pot maker like her mother and grandmother. However, Arenla, her mother, wanted her to become a weaver. On days when she managed to stay at home while her parents went to the fields, Sentila approached expert potters to learn the skill. They were at first amused by the little girl's insistence as they thought that she would soon outgrow her childish passion for the craft.

- I. *Contradict the view that Sentila's interest in pot making was a temporary childhood hobby.*
- II. *Which of the following statements best explains Sentila's attitude towards pot making?*
 - A Sentila was curious about pot making but easily influenced by others' opinions.
 - B Sentila showed strong determination and actively sought opportunities to learn the craft despite opposition.
- III. *What can be inferred about the expert potters' perception of Sentila's interest in pot making?*
- IV. *Read the following words from the extract.*

- (i) dream
- (ii) approached
- (iii) amused
- (iv) outgrow
- (v) insistence

Select the option that correctly categorises the words into Feelings/Mental State and Actions/Behaviour.

Options	Feelings/ Mental State	Action/ Behaviour
A	i, iii	ii, iv, v
B	i	ii, iv, v
C	i, iii	ii, v
D	i	iv, v

Extract 2

I shall not teach her pot making as it has brought no joy to me and only a pittance for my troubles. The riverbank, where the grey and red clay required for making pots is found, is sixteen kilometres from here. I need to climb down a sheer drop to the riverbank and my back aches from carrying the heavy load uphill all the way to the village. Pounding the stubborn clay inside bamboo cylinders to soften it is also tedious. So many times, I've dropped the mould out of sheer exhaustion and have had to start all over again. It takes months to bring out a batch of pots after so much labour. And the reward? A few rupees.

- I. *Explain why Arenla feels that pot making has brought her little reward despite hard labour.*
- II. *State one reason why Arenla is unwilling to teach Sentila pot making.*
- III. *What does the question mark in the line 'And the reward?' convey?*
 - (i) A sense of disappointment and irony.
 - (ii) A feeling of satisfaction after hard work.
 - (iii) An expression of frustration over low returns.
 - (iv) A tone of pride in her craft.
 - (v) A reflective pause highlighting contrast.

Choose the correct option.

- A Only ii B i, iii and v C ii and iv D Only v

Sentila continued her visits to watch the potters at work. She saw how the clay was mixed with water and pounded, how careful they were when they pushed their left hand into a lump of the softened clay and how deftly they rotated the lump as they started giving shape to the rotating clay with a spatula held in the right hand. The regular tap, tap of the spatula on the clay was music to her ears as she watched in fascination the pot emerging out of a shapeless lump right in front of her eyes. After two or three days, the pots would be given a final touch up to retain the required shape and to test the consistency. Only then would the pots be taken out to dry in the sun before being loaded.

- I. *Explain how the extract shows that Sentila learns pot making through careful observation rather than direct instruction.*
- II. *What is done to the pots before they are taken out to dry in the sun?*
- III. *What does the phrase 'the regular tap, tap of the spatula on the clay was music to her ears' convey?*
 - (i) Sentila finds the repeated action boring.
 - (ii) Sentila enjoys and feels emotionally connected to the process.
 - (iii) The sound distracts Sentila from her observation.
 - (iv) The work is noisy and tiring.
 - (v) The sound symbolises harmony and skill in the craft.

Extract Based Questions

Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Arenla heard of her daughter's visits but pretended to be ignorant of them. By late afternoon, Sentila had to return home quickly, so that when her mother came back from the fields, she would be there. Gradually, Sentila's visits became a topic of village gossip. People wondered why Arenla was refusing to teach the skill to her daughter. They were worried that if all pot makers followed suit, then there would be no expert potters to take their place. One day, Sentila's father, Mesoba, was summoned by the village council and asked to explain why Arenla was refusing to pass on the skill to her daughter.

I. What does the phrase 'pretended to be ignorant of them' convey about Arenla's attitude?

- (i) A deliberate avoidance of confrontation
- (ii) Complete lack of concern for Sentila's interest
- (iii) Inner conflict between concern and resistance
- (iv) Indifference towards traditional skills
- (v) Silent awareness without open opposition

Choose the correct option.

- A i, iii, v
- C ii and iv

- B Only ii
- D Only v

II. How does the mention of village gossip contribute to the theme of tradition in the story?

III. Select the option that correctly completes the following sentence.

The village council summoned Mesoba because they wanted to

- A punish Arenla for disobeying social customs.
- B understand why a traditional skill was not being passed on to the next generation.

IV. What emotion is the village community most likely expressing through their concern about Arenla's refusal to teach pot making?

Short Answer Type Questions

- Q.1 Explain the symbolic importance of the riverbank in Sentila's journey of learning pot making and how it represents an important stage in her growth.
- Q.2 Analyse the comparison of Sentila's work to that of a sprinter gaining momentum and explain how this image reflects her developing skill and confidence.
- Q.3 Why do the elders believe that skills like pot making do not 'belong' to any one individual?
- Q.4 Examine how the author uses descriptions of physical exhaustion and hard labour to emphasise the dignity, effort and value of skilled work.

Long Answer Type Questions

- Q.1 Analyse Arenla's dilemma as a mother and an artisan. How does the story present the conflict between passion, survival and responsibility?
- Q.2 Discuss how the understated ending strengthens the central message of 'The Pot Maker' about true learning and mastery.
- Q.3 The ending relies heavily on visual imagery rather than action. Examine how this choice reinforces the story's central ideas.

SCAN
For **ANSWERS**



Extract 1

The word punkha or pankha originates from the word 'pankh', which means feather of a bird. Pankha is used to refer to all fans, whereas the word pankhi denotes a small plumed fan used in ancient India. Evidence of the existence and use of pankhi in India can be found in Buddhist wall paintings at Ajanta. These wall paintings date back to the 2nd century CE. Other representations of the punkha can be found in embroidery work, sculptures and carvings.

I. *What does the reference to Buddhist wall paintings at Ajanta mainly convey about the pankhi?*

- (i) Its decorative appeal in ancient art.
- (ii) Its historical authenticity and early usage.
- (iii) Its exclusive use in religious rituals.
- (iv) Its evolution into modern craft forms.
- (v) Its association with royal patronage.

A i, iii, v

B Only ii

C ii and iv

D Only v

II. *How does the extract establish the historical significance of pankhi in ancient India?*

III. *Select the option that correctly completes the following.*
The term pankha is different from pankhi because pankha refers to

A a ceremonial object used only in temples.

B all types of fans, while pankhi denotes a small plumed fan used in ancient India.

For instance, the appliqué hand fan of Rajasthan is an antique pankha made of pieces of fabric in different shapes and patterns sewn onto another cloth with the use of ornamental needlework. Furthermore, the zardozi hand fan of Rajasthan differs in its use of glittering ornate and encrusted gold threadwork. In Rajasthan, temple hand fans are popular too. These are made by engraving brass and have a long handle. The painted hand fan, a cardboard pankha featuring various images, is usually offered to gods.

I. *What does the description of different hand fans of Rajasthan mainly emphasise?*

- (i) The exclusive use of fans in religious ceremonies.
- (ii) The diversity of materials and decorative techniques.
- (iii) The decline of traditional crafts in Rajasthan.
- (iv) The commercial production of hand fans.
- (v) The uniform design of Rajasthani pankhas.

A i, iii, v

B Only v

C ii and iv

D Only ii

II. *Explain how different techniques are used to make various types of hand fans in Rajasthan.*

III. *Select the option that correctly completes the following.*

The zardozi hand fan of Rajasthan is distinct because it

A is made of cardboard and offered to gods

B uses glittering ornate and encrusted gold threadwork

IV. *Which type of hand fan is usually offered to gods in Rajasthan?*

Extract Base
 Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.
 The adjoining state of Gujarat has its own indigenous take on pankhas. These hand fans are elegant pure cotton-based fans embellished with mirror work. The beaded hand fan is covered with colourful beads and has a silver handle. Gujarat is the centre for bead craft in India and these dainty pankhas are commonly used as wall decorations. Kutch is recognised for its hand-stitched leather and fans decorated with thread and wool at its fringes.

1. How does the extract highlight Gujarat's contribution to the tradition of pankha-making?
2. Which of the following statements best explains why Gujarat is an important centre for bead hand fans?
 - A Gujarat produces bead hand fans mainly for ritual purposes.
 - B Gujarat is the centre for bead craft, and its beaded pankhas are commonly used as wall decorations.

Why are Kutch hand fans considered distinctive?

Read the following words from the extract.

- (i) mirror work
- (ii) colourful beads
- (iii) silver handle
- (iv) thread and wool
- (v) leather

Select the option that correctly categorises the words into decorative features and base materials..

Options	Decorative Features	Base Materials
A	i, ii, iii	iv, v
B	i, ii, iv	iii, v
C	ii, iii, iv	i, v
D	i, iii	ii, iv, v

Short Answer Type Questions

- Q.1 Explain the reasons that made pankhas appear exotic and stylish in earlier times, with reference to their craftsmanship, materials and spread across regions.
- Q.2 Describe the variation in the size of pankhas and analyse what this variation reveals about their different uses in daily, religious and royal life.
- Q.3 Examine the role of trade routes in influencing the spread, popularity, and cultural value of pankhas across different regions of India.
- Q.4 How did pankhas shift from objects of personal use to sources of livelihood for artisans?
- Q.5 How has innovation contributed both positively and negatively to pankha culture?

Long Answer Type Questions

- Q.1 Analyse how pankhas reflect the everyday life and domestic culture of different regions of India, with suitable examples showing their materials, usage, and role in household life.
- Q.2 Examine the role of women artisans in sustaining the pankha-making tradition.
- Q.3 Analyse how pankhas have evolved from functional objects to symbols of craftsmanship and

Extract 1

"I wish," said Ravi's mother, hurriedly putting some green, red and orange tablets on a saucer, "that somebody would invent a memory—Vitamin-M... we could give it to old people to help them improve their memories." "Shh... Grandpa'll hear you," said Ravi, pointing to the frail old figure sitting in the rocking chair... "He doesn't hear too well, or see too well, or even remember too well these days."

- I. *Ravi's mother believes Grandpa needs a 'Memory Vitamin' because she thinks his memory has become weak. Do you agree with this statement based on the extract? Give a reason.*
- II. *Which of the following statements best explains Ravi's reaction in the extract?*
 - A Ravi agrees with his mother and laughs at Grandpa.
 - B Ravi feels concerned that Grandpa might hear his mother's comment.
- III. *What can be inferred about Grandpa's physical condition from the extract?*
- IV. *Read the following words from the extract.*
 - (i) hurriedly
 - (ii) pointing
 - (iii) holding
 - (iv) hear
 - (v) read

Select the option that correctly categorises them into Action Words and Sense-related Words.

Options	Action Words	Sense-related Words
A	i, ii, iii	iv, v
B	ii, iii, v	i, iv
C	i, iv	ii, iii, v
D	iii, iv	i, ii, v

picked up his beautiful shiny-black mahogany walking stick with a brass handle carved in the shape of an eagle's head, put on his bright-yellow cap and declared, "I'll be back home before you can set up the board, Ravi." Off he went, twirling his walking stick jauntily, leaving Ravi in a dilemma. His grandfather would feel hurt if he insisted on accompanying him and his mother would be furious if she knew Ravi would let him go out on his own.

- I. *Contradict the view that Ravi felt relaxed and confident after Grandpa left the house.*
- I. *Which of the following statements best explains why Ravi was in a dilemma?*
 - A He did not want to play chess.
 - B He was unsure whether to follow Grandpa or obey his mother.
- I. *What can be inferred about Grandpa's mood from the phrase 'twirling his walking stick jauntily'?*
- V. *Read the following words from the extract.*
 - (i) picked
 - (ii) twirling
 - (iii) declared
 - (iv) furious
 - (v) beautiful

Select the option that correctly categorises (i)-(v) into Action Words and Describing Words.

Options	Describing Words	Action Words
A	iv, v	i, ii, iii
B	ii, iii	i, iv, v
C	v	i, ii, iii, iv
D	iv	i, ii, iii, v